MONTHLY UPDATE

Libya: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-16-2 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *Developments reported in sources published between the beginning of last month and today, grouped by story, oldest first.*

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CAPACITY
Training and skills

INCLUSION
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DATA
National statistics

GEOPOLITICS
US / hyperscaler activities

Governance

Legislation and regulation

DECISION 449 OF 2026 ON IMPORTING THROUGH BANKING CHANNELS

- **بوشيحة يصدر قرارًا لتنظيم توريد السلع والبضائع عبر القنوات المصرفية اعتبارًا من 30 سبتمبر** — Libyan News Agency (LANA), 7 September 2026

  Libya's economy and trade minister Suhail Bushiha issued Decision No. 449 of 2026 on 7 September, banning the import of goods for trade outside banking channels from 30 September 2026. Customs may release commercial shipments only once banking, trade and customs requirements are met and the shipment's true value is documented; licensed individual traders get an annual import ceiling.

- **Tripoli Chamber of Commerce discusses decision to regulate imports for the purpose of trade** — Libya Herald, 15 September 2026

The capital's chamber of commerce met on the economy minister's decision 449 of 2026, which from 30 September requires importers and foreign exporters to register on the unified digital trade system. Members questioned whether the date can be met and what the decision will cost them.

Regional collaboration

ARAB STATES HIGH-LEVEL DIGITAL AND AI POLICY FORUM

- **UNDP, Ooredoo Group and Doha Institute for Graduate Studies convene Arab digital policy leaders to accelerate digital and AI policy implementation** — United Nations Development Programme, 2 September 2026

  UNDP, Ooredoo Group and the Doha Institute for Graduate Studies held a forum for Arab digital and AI policy leaders in Doha on 1–2 September 2026, with GSMA and Women in AI. It opened the country-level phase of the Digital Policy Framework for the Arab States, launched in November 2025. Libya's Minister of State for Digital Economy and AI, Ziad Abdelwaret Elhajjaji, took part.

Standards

HIGH TECHNICAL COMMITTEE FOR THE NATIONAL INFORMATION SYSTEM

- **During its sixth regular meeting in Tripoli, the High Technical Committee for the National Information System reviewed financial indicators and established rules for membership and future work** — General Information Authority (Libya), 6 September 2026

  Libya's High Technical Committee for the National Information System met in Tripoli on 1 September 2026 and ruled that permanent membership belongs to the director of each ministry's information and documentation centre, with proxies accepted only by official letter in emergencies. The finance ministry's information centre presented national financial-sector indicators and how they are produced.

Finance

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

PUBLIC BUDGET ALLOCATION TO DIGITAL GOVERNMENT

- **بيان مصرف ليبيا المركزي عن الإيراد والإنفاق من 01/01/2026 حتى 31/08/2026** — مصرف ليبيا المركزي (Central Bank of Libya), 10 September 2026

  The Central Bank of Libya's statement of revenue and expenditure for January to August 2026, released on 10 September, records spending of about 68.7 billion dinars and oil revenue of 80.8 billion. Telecommunications revenue was 31.1 million dinars, and the General Authority for Communications and its affiliates spent 25.2 million dinars, almost all on salaries and running costs.

- **بيان الإيراد والانفاق لشهر سبتمبر – 2026** — مصرف ليبيا المركزي (Central Bank of Libya), 8 October 2026

  The Central Bank of Libya's statement of state revenue and spending for January to September 2026, issued on 8 October, puts revenue at LYD 114.5bn, mostly from oil, and spending at LYD 88.6bn, of which LYD 1.6bn was development spending. Telecommunications brought in LYD 31.1m, and the General Authority for Communications spent about LYD 31.7m. It also lists electronic payment indicators.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

RETAIL MOBILE DATA TARIFFS

- **باقات إنترنت الهاتف المحمول** — شركة المدار الجديد (Almadar Aljadid), Libya, 3 September 2026

  A Libyan operator's live retail tariff card runs from 0.5 dinars for 50MB over one day to 80 dinars for 80GB over thirty. Libya publishes no regulated price basket, so operator cards are the only evidence of what data costs there.

SATELLITE BROADBAND OPERATOR MARKET ENTRY

- **Starlink's Libya Market Entry Remains on Hold as Negotiations Continue** — Space in Africa, 13 September 2026

  Talks between Starlink and Libya's General Authority for Communications and Informatics, open since 2024, had produced no agreement on licensing, spectrum or coverage as of 13 September 2026, according to regulator sources cited by Space in Africa. The regulator wants a local gateway in Libya, which Starlink has not accepted, though the company has agreed to set up a locally registered subsidiary.

NATIONAL EMERGENCY TELECOMMUNICATIONS PLAN (NETP)

- **هيئة الاتصالات تنظم ورشة عمل حول الخطة الوطنية للاتصالات في حالات الطوارئ** — The Libya Observer (Arabic), 28 September 2026

  Libya's telecoms authority and the ITU held a first two-day workshop in Tripoli to review the national emergency telecommunications plan, develop early-warning systems and a unified protocol, and set agencies' roles. The plan was conceived after communications with Derna and other eastern cities failed during Storm Daniel in 2023.

7,000 TELECOMMUNICATIONS TOWERS PROJECT

- **LPTIC Subsidiary Reviews Progress on 7,000 Telecom Towers Project** — Libya Herald, 3 October 2026

  Al-Bunya Investment and Services Company, a subsidiary of Libya's state telecoms holding company LPTIC, discussed its project for 7,000 telecommunications towers at its general assembly, reported on 3 October 2026. The company says the project aims to cut infrastructure operating costs, diversify revenue and use engineers from LPTIC's own companies. No progress figures, cost or timetable are given.

Data Storage

KM-4 DATA CENTRE CERTIFICATION

- **Uptime Institute — KM-4 Data Center, Libyan International Telecom Company** — Uptime Institute, 3 September 2026

  A tier III design certification is recorded for the Libyan national telecom company's KM-4 site, the first independent assessment of a Libyan facility the repository holds. It certifies design rather than construction or operation, and no capacity figures are disclosed.

Energy

OFF-GRID SOLAR ELECTRIFICATION OF REMOTE AREAS

- **مشروع كهربة المناطق النائية باستخدام منظومات الخلايا الشمسية** — جهاز الطاقات المتجددة (Renewable Energy Authority of Libya, REAOL), 3 September 2026

  Libya's renewable energy authority sets out its off-grid programme: 400 solar systems at 310 kW peak, serving remote population clusters and border posts. It is the largest counted state provision outside the cities the repository holds for the country.

Technical Capacity

NATIONAL DATA-CENTRE CAPACITY

- **Uptime Institute — KM-4 Data Center, Libyan International Telecom Company** — Uptime Institute, 3 September 2026

  Summarised under Data Storage.

TECHNICAL AND VOCATIONAL EDUCATION MINISTRY ELECTRONIC ARCHIVING SYSTEM (UPGRADE)

- **وزارة التعليم التقني والفني تعلن قرب إطلاق النسخة المحدثة من منظومة الأرشفة الإلكترونية** — وكالة الأنباء الليبية, 23 September 2026

  Libya's Ministry of Technical and Vocational Education said on 23 September 2026 that an upgraded version of its electronic archiving system is close to launch, with testing and approval under way and user training to follow. The ministry said the update adds stronger access controls, backups and security.

Cybersecurity

INTEGRATED NATIONAL CYBERSECURITY PLAN

- **مناقشة وضع خطة وطنية متكاملة للأمن السيبراني** — وكالة الأنباء الليبية (وال), 20 September 2026

  Libya's minister of state Mohammed bin Ghalboun chaired a meeting in Tripoli on 20 September 2026 on drawing up an integrated national cybersecurity plan, with the heads of the cybersecurity authority, the General Information Authority and the national information security authority. It covered cyber emergency plans, early warning, incident response and a joint mechanism to monitor compliance. No plan text or deadline was published.

NATIONAL OIL CORPORATION OIL-DATA LEAK INVESTIGATION

- **NOC officials in pre-trial detention for leaking sensitive oil-related data** — Libya Herald, 1 October 2026

  Libya's Attorney General's Office ordered two National Oil Corporation officials, one of them its director of information and digital transformation, into pre-trial detention over leaked oil-sector data. Data on fields, production, reserves and exploration passed to a foreign company contracted in 2023 for a sector study.

DPI

Digital Identity and CRVS

CIVIL-REGISTRY FRAUD ENFORCEMENT

- **إيقاف 3090 رقما وطنيا مزورا وإحالة متهمين للتحقيق** — ليبيا الأحرار, 10 September 2026

  Libya's Public Prosecutor halted 3,090 national identification numbers issued on forged civil-status data at the Majdul civil registry office, where investigators found failures in managing family records. The numbers had been used to obtain documents claiming citizenship rights. One suspect was remanded in custody and arrest orders were issued for others, within the jurisdiction of the Sebha Court of Appeal.

- **ظاهرة الأرقام الوطنية المزورة تتفاقم.. كيف نسد ثغرات السجل المدني الليبي؟** — Alwasat (Bawabat Al-Wasat), 27 September 2026

  Libya's public prosecutor announced another case of civil-status records falsified for money, reviving concern over forged national identity numbers, which the last official tally put above 89,000. The report traces the problem to 2022, when forged numbers were found to have drawn salaries and family grants, and asks how the civil registry's gaps can be closed.

- النائب العام يكشف تزوير 315 ألف رقم وطني وتجميد رواتب ومعاشات مرتبطة بها — Alwasat (Bawabat Al-Wasat), 13 October 2026

  Libya's Attorney General, Al-Siddiq Al-Sour, said on 13 October 2026 that a data review found more than 315,000 National Numbers issued unlawfully and over 10,000 passports issued on forged data. Authorities suspended 8,662 National Numbers, recalled 1,855 passports and froze LYD 84.5m in salaries and pensions. He also reported mismatches between the civil registry, National Number and voter databases.

Digital Payments and Fintech

GROSS VALUE OF ELECTRONIC PAYMENT OPERATIONS

- عيسى يناقش مع المصارف التجارية توفير السيولة والنقد الأجنبي — Libyan News Agency (LANA), 3 September 2026

  Central Bank of Libya governor Naji Issa met commercial banks and the payments company Moamalat in Tripoli on 3 September 2026 on cash liquidity, foreign-currency supply and the electronic payment system. The central bank put the gross value of electronic payments across all systems from 1 January to 31 August 2026 at about 764.9 billion Libyan dinars.

- **Electronic transactions reached 865 billion Libyan dinars by end of September 2026: CBL** — Libya Herald, 5 October 2026

  Libya's central bank said electronic transactions reached about 865 billion dinars by the end of September 2026. The figure came from a meeting between the governor, commercial bank heads and the state payments company on cash liquidity, wider electronic payment and cyber-risk readiness.

ACCESSION TO CHINA'S CROSS-BORDER INTERBANK PAYMENT SYSTEM

- **CBL Governor Naji Issa Launches New Financial Initiatives** — Libya Herald, 7 September 2026

  Libya's central bank governor launched a link to the Arab regional payments platform, a study track on a central bank digital currency and stablecoins, and a cyber-skills programme, and put a pilot for accession to China's cross-border interbank system at early 2027. None of the four carries an instrument, budget, participant list or delivery date.

CENTRAL BANK PAYMENT AND DIGITAL-CURRENCY INITIATIVES

- **CBL Governor Naji Issa Launches New Financial Initiatives** — Libya Herald, 7 September 2026

  Summarised under Digital Payments and Fintech.

ZERO CASH CASHLESS INITIATIVE

- «منتدى تطوير القطاع المصرفي يعلن التوقف عن متابعة تنفيذ مبادرة «صفر نقد — Alwasat (Bawabat Al-Wasat), 7 September 2026

  Libya’s banking sector development forum said it has stopped pursuing its cashless initiative in the form submitted to the central bank, because the executive framework it needed was never issued.

DIRECT PAYMENT CORRIDOR TO CHINA

- **Libya's North Africa Bank to launch direct payment service to China using Alipay** — Libya Herald, 8 September 2026

  A privately owned Libyan bank said it will launch a direct mobile payment service to China, capped at US$5,000 a transaction and US$50,000 a year.

CENTRAL BANK CIRCULAR 9/2026 ON MOBILE PAYMENT AND ELECTRONIC WALLETS

- **مصرف ليبيا المركزي يضع ضوابط جديدة للمحافظ الإلكترونية ويرفع سقف التحويل اليومي إلى مليوني دينار للشركات - Bankawy** — Bankawy - 14 سهلنا عليك المشوار, قارن .. أختار .. أفهم September 2026

  The Central Bank of Libya issued Circular 9/2026 on mobile payments and e-wallets, reported on 14 September 2026. It lets licensed payment companies issue wallets to legally resident foreigners with a valid passport or residence document. Daily limits for Libyan citizens are 100,000 dinars person to person, 500,000 person to company and 2 million company to company; foreigners' limits are lower.

RATIBAK LAHZI REAL-TIME PAYROLL

- **The Central Bank of Libya announces the commencement of September salary payments through the "Your Salary Instantly" system** — Central Bank of Libya, 28 September 2026

  The Central Bank of Libya began paying September 2026 public-sector salaries through its "Your Salary Instantly" system on 28 September. About 1.75 million of 2.2 million public employees are registered, a 79% participation rate. The bank is working with the Ministry of Finance to automate complaints about unpaid salaries.

Registries

UNIFIED ECONOMIC NUMBER

- **بدء العمليات التجريبية لإصدار الرقم الاقتصادي الموحد إلكترونياً** — Alwasat (Bawabat Al-Wasat), 9 September 2026

  Libya's National Council for the Unified Economic Number began pilot electronic issuance of a single identifier for economic, commercial and investment entities on 9 September 2026, under Cabinet Decision No. 348 of 2026. Applicants' National Number must match the phone number registered to it. The number is issued free through the Dawlati government services platform.

- **Pilot operations started for the soon-to-be-launched Unified Economic Number** — Libya Herald, 10 September 2026

  Libya's national council for the Unified Economic Number has approved the start of pilot operations for issuing the number electronically. It opens the first phase of a project to give economic, commercial and investment entities a single identity, implementing a Cabinet decision of 2026.

COMPULSORY REGISTRATION ON THE UNIFIED DIGITAL TRADE SYSTEM

- **Economy Ministry makes electronic registration mandatory for importers and exporters** — The Libya Observer, 15 September 2026

  The requirement bites in stages: a transitional period runs to the end of 2026, then from January 2027 for businesses whose annual transactions or shipments are worth US$1m or more.

- **Mandatory registration of importers and exporters in unified digital system for trade (PTS) announced by Ministry of Economy** — Libya Herald, 15 September 2026

  Decree 465 of 2026 makes registration on the unified digital trade system compulsory for importers, exporters and foreign companies supplying the market through Libyan companies, issuing a registration certificate and an electronic identification number.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

ELECTRONIC VISA APPLICATIONS AND APPROVALS

- **مركز خدمة المواطن يبحث دعم منظومة التأشيرة الإلكترونية** — ليبيا أوبزيرفر (Libya Observer, Arabic), 5 September 2026

Libya's Citizen Service Centre and the Passports, Nationality and Foreigners Affairs Authority agreed a joint technical and administrative support mechanism for the national E-Visa system, reported on 5 September 2026. It will receive and process enquiries and complaints from citizens and residents and unify communication between the agencies involved. No date or resources are given.

CUSTOMS AUTOMATED INSPECTION AND COASTAL MONITORING CONTRACTS

- **"Leading international companies" discuss with Customs Authority activating automated inspection contracts & projects** — Libya Herald, 16 September 2026

  Libya's Customs Authority met foreign contractors on 15 September 2026 to revive automated inspection, container scanning and coastal monitoring contracts signed in earlier years but never completed. The meeting reviewed what had been delivered and what had blocked the rest; no contract values or dates were given.

UNIFIED NATIONAL DATABASE FOR INTERNATIONAL SUPPORT

- **المركزي» يبحث إنشاء منظومة إلكترونية وقاعدة بيانات موحدة للدعم الدولي»** — بوابة الوسط, 21 September 2026

  Libya's central bank governor, Naji Issa, put forward an electronic system and a single national database for recording and following up international grants, projects and support. He made the proposal on 21 September 2026 at the second meeting of the committee set up under prime-ministerial decision 422 of 2026. The idea is still under discussion and has not been adopted.

ATHAR AUDIT-TASK PLATFORM

- **ديوان المحاسبة ينظم ندوة تعريفية لمنصة (أثر) لإدارة ومتابعة المهام الرقابية .** — Libyan News Agency (LANA), 8 October 2026

  Libya's Audit Bureau presented its Athar platform for managing and following up audit tasks to more than 140 audited bodies at a seminar in Tripoli on 7 October 2026. Bureau head Khaled Shakshak said it is the digital channel for communication and information exchange between the Bureau and the bodies it audits.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

MUNICIPAL RECORDS DIGITALISATION

- **بلدية أبوسليم تبدأ تطبيق منظومة الأرشفة الإلكترونية بإدارة الموارد البشرية** — Libyan News Agency (LANA), 11 September 2026

  Abu Salim municipality in Tripoli, Libya, began using an electronic archiving system in its human resources department on 11 September 2026, storing staff data, records and documents electronically. The municipality says it will speed retrieval and reduce reliance on paper. No supplier or cost is given.

Rural digital data capture

RURAL DIGITAL SERVICE PROGRAMME

- **مشروع كهربة المناطق النائية باستخدام منظومات الخلايا الشمسية** — جهاز الطاقات المتجددة (Renewable Energy Authority of Libya, REAOL), 3 September 2026

  Summarised under Energy.

Capacity

Training and skills

WASL INITIATIVE FOR DIGITAL EMPOWERMENT AND ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

- **الإعلان في طرابلس عن إطلاق مبادرة (وَصْل) للتمكين الرقمي والذكاء الاصطناعي بقطاع الشؤون الاجتماعية** — Libyan News Agency (WAL), 10 October 2026

  Libya's Ministry of Social Affairs and the Minister of State for Digital Economy and Artificial Intelligence signed a memorandum launching the Wasl initiative at the Libya AI Forum in Tripoli on 10 October 2026. It has two tracks: digital and AI skills for social affairs staff, and digital access for persons with disabilities. No budget or timetable is given.

Inclusion

Access to services

RAQIB COMPLAINTS AND REPORTING PLATFORM

- **منصة رقيب للشكاوي والبلاغات** — هيئة الرقابة الإدارية, 3 September 2026

  Libya's administrative oversight authority has a live complaints and reporting platform covering about 750 reportable state bodies. It launched at a Tripoli anti-corruption event in December 2025; no count of reports received or resolved is published.

UNIVERSITY ACCESS TO A FOREIGN DIGITAL LIBRARY

- **British Council signs MoU with Benghazi University allowing access to the Council's Digital Library to 70,000 students** — Libya Herald, 9 September 2026

  The British Council signed a memorandum with the University of Benghazi giving more than 70,000 students access to its Digital Library of over 80,000 resources, the British Embassy announced on 9 September 2026. The university lost much of its library collection during the war. No cost is stated.

Data

National statistics

ENGINEERING REPORT OF INDUSTRIAL AND ENVIRONMENTAL INDICATORS

- **Green Industry Centre report provides valuable sector data for policy and plan formulation** — Libya Herald, 10 September 2026

  Libya's industry ministry has published an engineering report of industrial and environmental indicators compiled from its own database of facilities. It records 305 registered industrial establishments, 301 of them private, and 26,034 workers, alongside data on industrial activity, resource and energy consumption and waste management.

UNIFIED DIRECTORY FOR NATIONAL INDICATORS

- **The General Authority for Information continues its technical meetings to follow up on the work of the Unified Directory for National Indicators with sectoral information centers - GIA** — GIA - General Authority for Information, 15 September 2026

  Libya's General Authority for Information met information centres from the Prime Minister's Office and the ministries of oil and gas, marine wealth, economy and trade, and vocational education in Tripoli on 14 September 2026 to work on a Unified Directory for National Indicators. Each body is to send its draft to the authority, which will prepare a final version for approval by the High Technical Committee for the National Information System.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

> STRATEGIC COOPERATION FRAMEWORK WITH THE UNITED STATES ON TELECOMMUNICATIONS AND TECHNOLOGY
>
> - **Libya and the US Sign Strategic Cooperation Framework** — Libyan News Agency, 8 October 2026
>
> Libya's communications authority and the US State Department signed a cooperation framework in Washington covering digital infrastructure, AI, data centres, cybersecurity and satellite communications. No programme or amount was published.

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